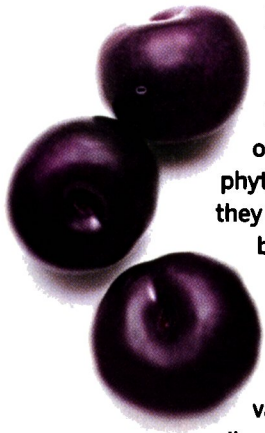


Plum Truth

Plums are the new super-food. Full of antioxidants and phytonutrients, they help the body prevent diseases—especially cancer and cardiovascular ailments. Plums

are also low in calories and are fat-free. But don't peel your plums. Eat the skin as well because that's where many of the colour agents and antioxidants are.



It's Unhappiness, Not the Workload

Bangalore techies are known to suffer from psychological disorders. But if you thought it's just the work pressure, think again. Around 93 per cent of corporate Bangalore is unhappy at work, reports a health risk assessment study conducted by PeopleHealth, a health management organisation, on 2,106 employees of seven leading IT firms in the city. Unhappiness among employees was primarily due to a combination of long office hours, hostile work atmosphere, uncooperative colleagues and rude bosses. These seem to create more negative feelings than not getting a promotion or pay hike, reports the study.

100

BOUTS OF LAUGHTER
A DAY EQUAL 15
MINUTES ON AN
EXERCISE BIKE.

Gender Gap in Matters of the Heart

The October issue of the *Archives of Internal Medicine* reports a curious gender gap. While middle-aged men continue to have a higher prevalence of myocardial infarction than women of similar age (especially those below 55), the risk is increasing in women and coming down in men. But women's chances of surviving a heart attack have increased. The reduced risk of death was greatest in women younger than 55 years (53 per cent reduction) and least in men of the same age (33 per cent).



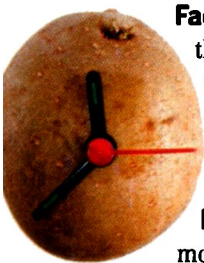
Calorie Facts

Myth Exercise makes you eat more.

Fact Research shows that even after 20 minutes of working out, people don't eat more than non-exercisers.

Myth Consuming most of your calories in the evening leads to weight gain.

Fact No matter when you eat, you gain weight if you consume more calories than you burn off.



THE POSTURE EFFECT

Everybody, at some point or the other, has been barked at by elders for not sitting straight. Apart from helping your bones, joints and muscles, good posture is supposed to contribute to a healthy appearance. But researchers now say that the straight-back, chest-out position can also affect how you think. Psychologists at the Ohio State University, US, whose findings appeared in the October issue of the *European Journal of Social Psychology*, claim that most people assume their confidence comes from their thoughts and don't realise how much their posture affects what they think.

■ Compiled by **Damayanti Datta**